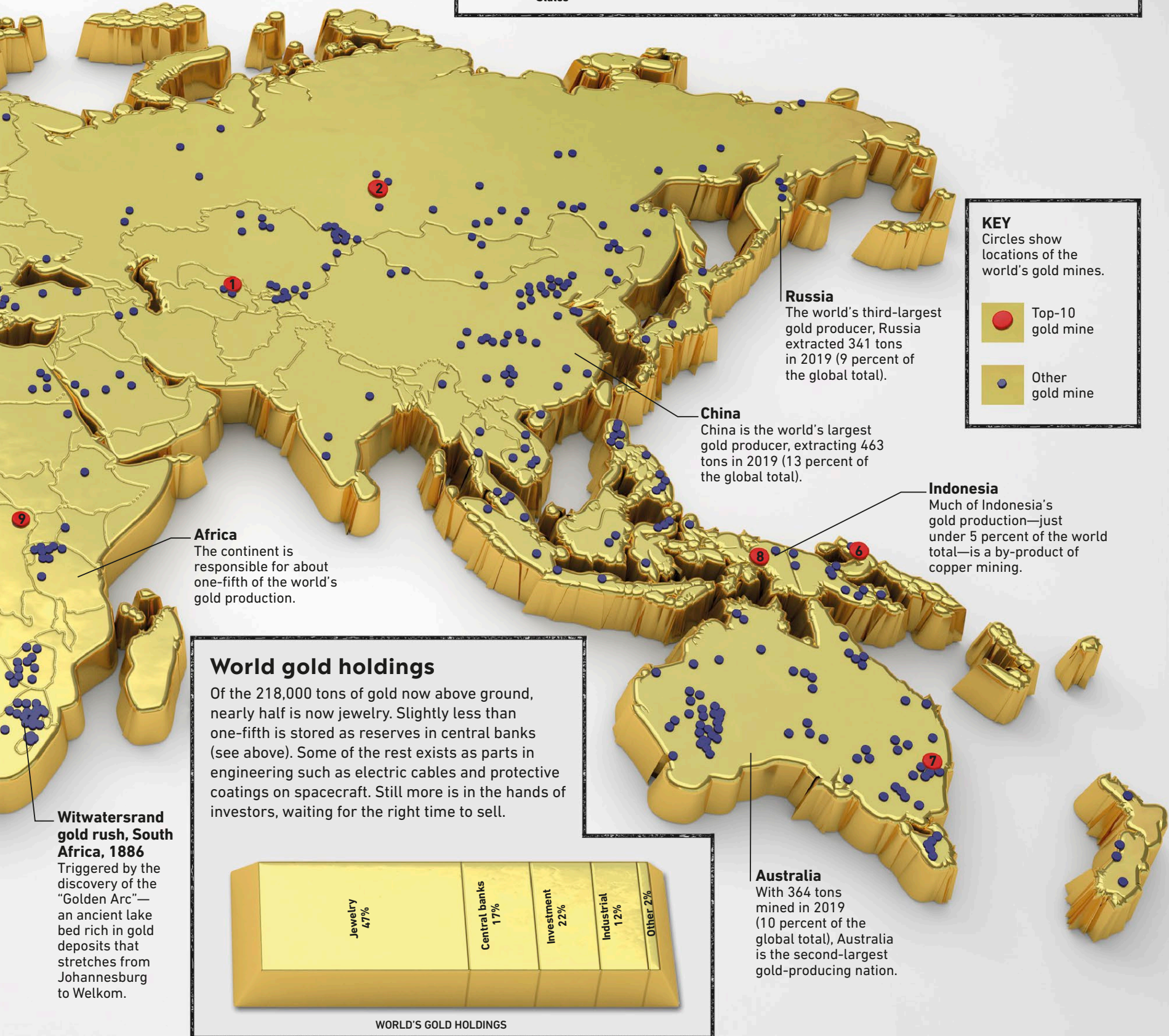
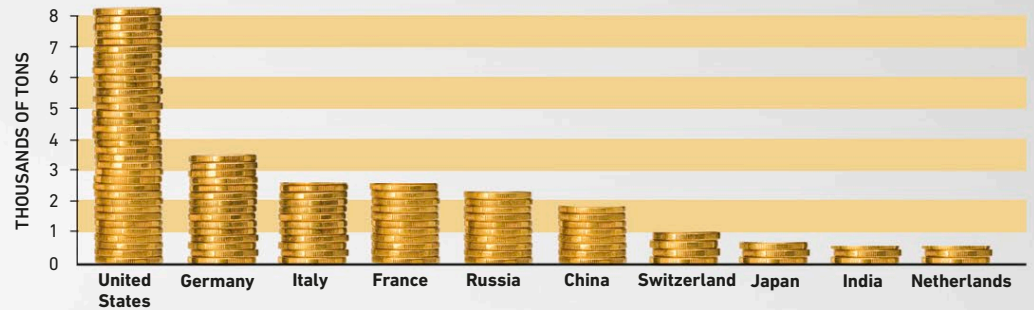


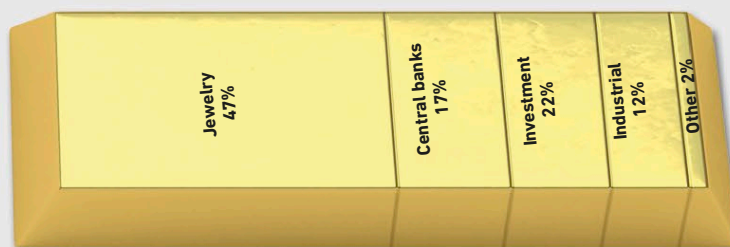
Gold reserves

The central banks of the world's nations store gold to back up their currencies. The Federal Reserve in the US has the largest gold reserves. There are also international gold reserves, such as those held by the International Monetary Fund.



World gold holdings

Of the 218,000 tons of gold now above ground, nearly half is now jewelry. Slightly less than one-fifth is stored as reserves in central banks (see above). Some of the rest exists as parts in engineering such as electric cables and protective coatings on spacecraft. Still more is in the hands of investors, waiting for the right time to sell.



WORLD'S GOLD HOLDINGS